Project 5 — Advanced Techniques

CSN IT Help Desk Reference · Unit 2 — Word Processing · Capstone Project · 100 points · 14 tasks

How to use this instruction sheet. Download the starter file from the Project Grader, open it in Microsoft Word 365, and keep this sheet open beside it. This capstone covers advanced Word techniques — special characters, section-specific page setup, table conversions, and graphic elements. Work through each task in order. Each task tells you what to do, why it matters, and where to find the tool. When you're done, save the file and upload it to the Project 5 grader for instant scoring.

Advanced Techniques

100 points · 14 tasks

Task 1 — Apply a light blue page color to the cover page

5 pt

WHY THIS MATTERS

A subtle page color makes the cover page stand out from the rest of the document and reinforces a branded look.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Design tab → Page Background group → Page Color → choose a light blue. (To color only the cover, the cover must be its own section.)

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

The cover page has a light blue background while the rest of the document stays white.

Task 2 — Add a box border around the entire document

5 pt

WHY THIS MATTERS

A page border frames the document and gives it a finished, formal appearance.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Design tab → Page Background group → Page Borders → Box → choose a style → Apply to: Whole document.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

A box border appears around the page margins on every page.

Task 3 — Insert a hyperlink to the CSN IT Help Desk support portal

8 pt

WHY THIS MATTERS

Hyperlinks let readers jump straight to an online resource — essential in a help-desk document.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Select the link text → Insert tab → Links group → Link (Ctrl+K) → enter the portal URL → OK.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

The text becomes a clickable, underlined hyperlink pointing to the support portal.

Task 4 — Insert a degree symbol (°) in the Fahrenheit troubleshooting note

5 pt

WHY THIS MATTERS

Special symbols like the degree sign communicate technical values precisely (e.g., operating-temperature ranges).

WHERE TO FIND IT

Click where the symbol belongs → Insert tab → Symbols group → Symbol → More Symbols → find ° (Degree Sign) → Insert.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

The degree symbol (°) appears in the Fahrenheit note, e.g. “95°F”.

Task 5 — Insert a column break in the two-column FAQ section

8 pt

WHY THIS MATTERS

A column break forces the text after it to the top of the next column, controlling exactly where each column's content begins.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Click where the next column should start → Layout tab → Page Setup group → Breaks → Column.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

The text after the break jumps to the top of the second column.

Task 6 — Change the FAQ section's page setup to 0.75-inch margins

9 pt

WHY THIS MATTERS

Using a section break lets one section (the FAQ) have tighter 0.75-inch margins to fit more content, while the rest of the document keeps its standard margins.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Click in the FAQ section → Layout tab → Margins → Custom Margins → set all to 0.75" → Apply to: This section.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

The FAQ section's margins are 0.75" while the rest of the document is unchanged.

Task 7 — Convert the tab-separated ticket priority list to a table

9 pt

WHY THIS MATTERS

Word can turn tab-delimited text directly into a structured table, instantly organizing the data.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Select the tab-separated lines → Insert tab → Table → Convert Text to Table → confirm the column count and separator (Tabs) → OK.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

The list becomes a proper table with rows and columns.

Task 8 — Convert the outdated software version table back to plain text

8 pt

WHY THIS MATTERS

The reverse operation — turning a table back into text — is useful when tabular structure is no longer wanted.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Click in the table → Table Layout tab → Data group → Convert to Text → choose a separator → OK.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

The table becomes plain text separated by your chosen character; no table grid remains.

Task 9 — Increase the cell margins on the equipment table for readability

5 pt

WHY THIS MATTERS

Adding internal cell margins gives table text breathing room so it doesn't crowd the cell borders.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Click in the table → Table Layout tab → Alignment group → Cell Margins → increase the values → OK.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

Text inside the equipment table has more space around it within each cell.

Task 10 — Split the merged header cell in the ticket table into two columns

8 pt

WHY THIS MATTERS

Splitting a cell divides it into multiple cells — the opposite of merging — useful for separating combined headings.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Click the merged header cell → Table Layout tab → Merge group → Split Cells → set 2 columns → OK.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

The single header cell becomes two separate cells.

Task 11 — Resize the equipment table columns to fit their content

5 pt

WHY THIS MATTERS

AutoFit sizes each column to its widest content, eliminating wasted space and awkward wrapping.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Click in the table → Table Layout tab → Cell Size group → AutoFit → AutoFit Contents.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

Each column width snugly fits its content.

Task 12 — Split the long software inventory table into two separate tables

9 pt

WHY THIS MATTERS

Splitting a table breaks one large table into two independent tables at a chosen row — helpful for separating categories or letting a section start fresh.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Click in the row that should begin the second table → Table Layout tab → Merge group → Split Table.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

There are now two distinct tables with a paragraph gap between them.

Task 13 — Apply a custom bullet character (checkmark) to the quick-fix list

8 pt

WHY THIS MATTERS

A custom bullet — such as a checkmark — gives a list a purposeful, branded look beyond the default dot.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Select the list → Home tab → Bullets dropdown → Define New Bullet → Symbol → choose a checkmark → OK.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

Each item in the quick-fix list is marked with a checkmark bullet.

Task 14 — Insert a rounded rectangle shape to highlight the emergency contact box

8 pt

WHY THIS MATTERS

A shape drawn around key information (like an emergency contact) draws the reader's attention to it.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Insert tab → Illustrations group → Shapes → Rounded Rectangle → draw it around the emergency contact text.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

A rounded rectangle frames the emergency contact information.

Total: 100 points · 14 tasks. Every task on this sheet is graded automatically when you upload your file. © Dr. Mark Taormino